

KICKSTARTER

For creators

Log in

 Search projects, creators, and categories

Crafts Dance Design Fashion Film Food Games Journalism Music Photography Publishing Technology Theater



webframes

WebFrames: Animated Images for the Web

Cross-browser animated images using SVG and CSS.

**Steven Vachon**

First created • 0 backed

More

\$88 

pledged of \$17,653 goal

10

backers



Software



Toronto, Canada

Funding Unsuccessful

The project's funding goal was not reached on Sat, August 2 2014 9:38 PM UTC +06:00

 **Last updated** [August 2, 2014](#)[Campaign](#)[Rewards](#)[Creator](#)[FAQ](#) ³[Updates](#) ⁰[Comments](#) ⁶[Community](#)

Story

An easy-to-use Tool

WebFrames is a sum of two custom, open-source software applications and a "new" image format. It allows you to generate an animated file containing bitmap and vector artwork with transparency that works in all major web browsers.

WebFrames automates a complex and tedious process of importing images and exporting an SVG file with machine-accurate embedded CSS animations.

It will be available as a visual editor for graphic designers (Sparkle Motion) and as a command-line utility for developers.

What's different about it?

WebFrames images...

- can contain bitmap and/or vector artwork
- can be lossy (bitmap only) or lossless
- do not have the quality limitations of GIF
- do not have the browser limitations of APNG, MNG, WebP or video
- do not require JavaScript or a plugin
- use technology already present in current web browsers

While other web animation utilities allow you to animate an object, they do not allow you to change the object itself in a key framed sequence. One such example—as seen in the video—would be the comparison between rotating the letter "S" and a cartoon snake travelling in a figure-eight knot.

Reach a larger audience

WebFrames images seamlessly reach audiences that you would normally have to make sacrifices for. Use them in emails, landing pages, "noscript"

Funding period

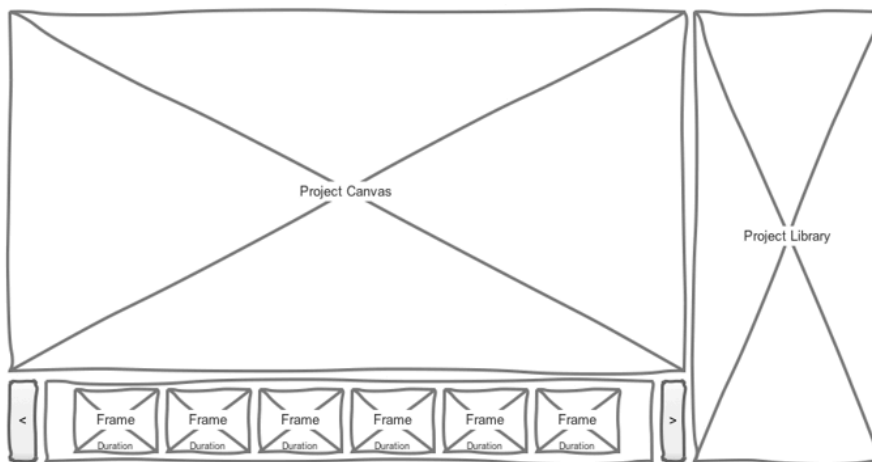
Jul 3 2014 - Aug 2 2014 (30 days)

fallbacks and all major web browsers.

Quick integration

WebFrames animated images can be linked to or embedded as you would any other image (or background-image). It remains a single asset that is kept clear of any code unrelated to the design team. No need to involve a developer.

Visual Editor (Sparkle Motion)



Sparkle Motion is a creative application allowing non-programmers to create and edit animated images. It is planned for Mac, Windows and Linux. It provides a visual interface to the command line utility that runs in the background. The title of this editor is inspired by the movie Donnie Darko and a nod to the silly "Sparkle" codename of Microsoft Silverlight during Adobe/Macromedia Flash's reign.

Command Line/API

```

-$ webframes -h
WEBFRAMES (v0.0.1)

Usage
  webframes [OPTIONS]

Options
  --contain, -c          Contain export within a data-uri <image>.
  --duration             The duration of each frame in milliseconds (default=33).
  --css-export, -a       Export as CSS animations.
  --export               The exported SVG file.
  --file                 A file to import. Can be used multiple times.
  --folder               A folder of files to import.
  --help, -h, -?        Display this help text.
  --lossy, -l            Use lossy (JPEG) compression.
  --lossy-png, -p        Use lossy (JPEG) compression on 24-bit transparent PNGs.
  --minify-export, -e     Minify media on export.
  --minify-import, -i    Minify media on import.
  --open                A project file to open.
  --quality              Lossy compression level (0-100, default=80).
  --save                The saved project file (*.wfp).
  --version, -v          Print the webframes version.

```

For the developers, a command line utility is available for automation use in any project. If you're building with Node.js, a programmatic API is available offering better performance. Currently works on Linux and Mac servers with planned Windows support.

Extend browser support of exports from other animation programs

Using a component of WebFrames ([smil2css](#)), SVG animations exported from other applications can finally be production ready in Internet Explorer *and* without the use of runtime JavaScript. Additionally, animation performance will be improved in other browsers such as Chrome and Firefox.

How does it work?

WebFrames is a [Node.js](#) and [CanJS](#) application written almost entirely in JavaScript with a few dependent libraries written in C/C++. It will be available via the WebFrames website and [NPM](#), making it extremely simple (and fast!) to install on all major environments.

The exported image is a combination of CSS, SVG and a fair share of previously unfathomed techniques.

WebFrames can import GIF, JPEG, PNG, SVG and export an animation with or without image compression. Vector graphics will not be rasterized, but will remain lossless. There's even an experimental feature where JPEG compression is applied to transparent 24-bit PNG images (not compatible with Safari 7).

Additionally, WebFrames will be released under the [MIT License](#) which means you can do pretty much whatever you want with it. Include WebFrames in anything you want and release under any license you want.

Where are we now?

Progress has been slow since it began in March. As mentioned in the video, there is a working prototype—but there is still a lot to do.

With your support, the first complete release of WebFrames can make its way out to the world. Your backing will fund:

- Development time. The plan is to work on WebFrames and nothing but WebFrames for the next 3 months with the first public version shipping

in November.

- Domain + hosting fees. WebFrames' website will serve compiled downloads, examples and documentation.

Made for Love, not for Profit

For the love of quality and its users, WebFrames does not set out to make a profit. It will be released free and open source to everyone.

The people behind WebFrames

My name is Steven Vachon. I'm a Front-End Engineer who began as a graphics and UX designer but found a love for writing code. Since 1999, I have been building (and designing) applications for all devices and environments for companies like AT&T, New York Times, Benjamin Moore, Moen, Wilkinson Sword and many others.

Risks and challenges

With a software development project like this, the biggest risk and challenge is inevitably shipping on time. To combat delays, we'll be setting regular milestones and making sure we hit them as well as keeping our backers updated. We will be prioritising schedule above features.

[Learn about accountability on Kickstarter](#)

Questions about this project? [Check out the FAQ](#)

[Report this project to Kickstarter](#)

Similar projects to check out

[See more](#)



Save our oceans. Take Wildtype mainstream.

Justin Kolbeck



Zen Tea Brew Infusions: Discover Delicious Rare Shizuoka Tea



Faire in the Field: Year Two!

Patrick Munroe-Smith





Laughing Gull Chocolates Take Flight

Lindsay

10 days left • 81% funded



- Discover

Arts

Comics & Illustration

Design & Tech

Film

Food & Craft

Games

Music

Publishing
- About

About us

Our charter

Press

Jobs
- Support

Help Center

Our Rules

Creator Resources

Forward Funds

Brand assets
- More

Newsletters

Kickstarter Project Updates

The Creative Independent

Mobile apps

Research

KICKSTARTER

English

\$ US Dollar (USD)

